

Introduction to GIMP

Learning Objectives

- Open and navigate the GIMP interface
- Identify key toolbox elements and menus
- Create and save a new image file

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a village artist who paints banners for festivals. They use brushes, colors, a palette, and a canvas. GIMP is like a digital artist's studio—it has brushes, colors, layers, and a canvas on your computer screen. Today we enter this powerful free painting studio.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open GIMP on your computer. Explore the interface: the toolbox on the left, the canvas in the center, and the layers panel on the right. Click on different tools and see what happens. Try creating a new file and setting the canvas size to 800 by 600 pixels.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

GIMP (GNU Image Manipulation Program) is a free, open-source image editor similar to Photoshop. The toolbox contains selection tools, paint brushes, text tools, and more. The canvas is your workspace where you create and edit images. The layers panel helps you organize different parts of your image. Always save your work in GIMP's native format (.xcf) to preserve layers.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Imagine setting up a rangoli design. You start with a base outline, add colors layer by layer, and adjust details. GIMP works the same way—you build your image using different tools and layers. What would you create if you had a digital canvas: a poster for your school, a greeting card, or a photo edit?

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three parts of the GIMP interface and their functions. Then save a blank image as "practice.xcf" in your folder. If you finish early, try using the pencil tool to draw a simple shape.